

What's Still Running

Early in the last week, after a sit. Plan on thirty to forty-five minutes. Keep it. You'll bring a piece of it to your Integration and Next-Step Session.

A month in, some of the pattern has loosened and some of it is still running you. No shame. We don't do shame here. Name it plainly, so we know what to work on together.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Five minutes of breath. Five in, seven out. Note the quality of mind you're starting with. Then open your eyes and begin.

1. THE PATTERN YOU KEEP MEETING

Over the four weeks, what's the one pattern that kept showing up? The same kind of moment, the same reaction, the same story. Describe it in a few sentences, the way you'd tell me.

2. WHERE IT SHOWS UP FIRST

Close your eyes and bring one of those moments back. Where does it show up in the body first, before the story? Throat, chest, belly, jaw, shoulders. What's the quality? That's the signal you'll want to catch earlier.

3. THE PROTECTOR YOU KEEP BUMPING INTO

When you turn toward it, what's the protection that shows up first? The mind speeding up, going blank, fixing, disappearing, the critic. Name it. Then, with a little less argument than usual: what's it protecting? Thank it for what it's been doing.

4. THE TRADE UNDERNEATH

In that pattern, what are you trading, and for what? In exchange for _____, I keep _____. One plain sentence.

5. WHAT YOU'VE BRUSHED

All month you've been staying with the tightness. If you've brushed something more tender underneath it, in a sit or a journal, write what you know about it so far. Where it lives, what it's like, how old it feels. If you haven't, write that. Either is the right answer. Don't dig. Just report.

6. WHAT YOU'D WANT HELP WITH

If you and I had an hour, and we will, what would you want help with? Not what you think you should say. What's still running you, that you'd like to stop doing alone.

TO CARRY INTO THE WEEK

One line. The pattern, named plainly, the way you'd say it to yourself when you catch it next time.